Modi and Starlink Research Report

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Research Report: Narendra Modi, Starlink, and India's Satellite Internet Landscape

Executive Summary
This report examines the regulatory journey, strategic interactions, and recent developments surrounding Elon Musk’s satellite internet venture, **Starlink**, and its entry into the Indian market under Prime Minister **Narendra Modi’s** administration.

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1. Background & Regulatory Milestones
* **Initial Application:** Starlink applied for a Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite Services (GMPCS) license in India back in 2022.
* **Key Approvals:** Over the past few years, Starlink received initial authorization from India's space agency (IN-SPACe) and a satellite communications license from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
* **Security & Compliance:** Entry into India required adherence to strict national security protocols, data localization mandates, lawful interception capabilities, and gateway security clearances. Starlink submitted necessary undertakings to comply with these revised guidelines.

2. High-Level Engagements: Modi & Elon Musk
* **Leadership Meetings:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Elon Musk have held high-profile discussions—including meetings in the United States—to navigate Starlink's long-delayed plans for India.
* **Strategic Partnerships:** To facilitate its market integration, Starlink engaged extensively with Indian regulators and local telecom operators, forging preliminary cooperation frameworks with India's dominant telecom players, Reliance Jio (Mukesh Ambani) and Bharti Airtel (Sunil Mittal).

3. Market Competition & Recent Challenges
* **Spectrum and Licensing Debates:** The race for satellite broadband spectrum in India has involved intense competition between global players like Starlink, Amazon's Project Kuiper, and domestic giants like Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel.
* **Security Scrutiny:** Regulatory scrutiny intensified following incidents where unauthorized Starlink hardware was intercepted in sensitive border and island regions (such as Manipur and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands).
* **Current Status:** While Starlink has secured essential licenses and letters of intent, it continues to undergo rigorous security assessments alongside competitors like Eutelsat OneWeb and Jio’s satellite venture, awaiting final commercial rollout clearances.

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*Report compiled via independent web research regarding Modi administration policies, regulatory

updates, and Starlink's operational status in India.*